

using the technology. The early 802.11 products suffered from interoperability since IEEE had no provision for testing equipment. The IEEE 802.11b saw companies endorsing the specification and witnessed the formation of the Wireless Ethernet Compatibility Alliance (WECA) and branded the technology Wi-Fi. The group of companies included 3Com, Cisco, Intersil, Agere and Motorola. The list of course details their current names and not the names the Alliance was formed under. The organisation was set up in order to perform testing, certify the inter-operability of electronic devices claiming adherence to 802.11 specifications and promote the technology as a whole. It was renamed the Wi-Fi Alliance in 2000. The Alliance owns and controls the prolific Wi-Fi certified logo, a registered trademark that is permitted only on tested equipment. The rigorous certification process ensures high adherence to brand standards, reliability, security and interoperability.



Wi-Fi Alliance

The focus is on:

- Compatibility and interoperability where the product being tested is tested for connectivity with other certified equipment. Testing is done with multiple devices from different equipment manufacturers.
- Conformance to standards and backward compatibility. Since technology keeps evolving, it is essential that all new technology is perfectly compatible with its earlier versions. High adherence and conformance to the 802.11 standards is also essential.
- High performance standards in order to meet end user requirements. Each product must maintain certain minimum standards in order to be certified by the Wi-Fi Alliance. Specific performance test results are however, not released by the Alliance to the public.